Northwind Labs - Operations Employee Handbook

Sample - fictional company. All names, policies, and figures are invented for demonstration purposes.

Effective October 1, 2026. Maintained by Human Resources (Sophia Martinez, Head of HR).

1. Welcome and Purpose

Welcome to the Operations department at Northwind Labs. Operations runs Northwind Labs' facilities, IT, and internal logistics, including the warehouse and shipping functions that support hardware products.

This handbook covers policies specific to Operations employees. The department is led by Devon Miller (Head of Operations). Where this handbook and a company-wide policy differ, this handbook applies to Operations employees.

2. Work Hours and Offices

Operations works in two shifts. The day shift runs 7:00 AM to 3:30 PM and the evening shift runs 2:00 PM to 10:30 PM, Monday through Friday. Shift swaps must be approved by a shift lead at least 48 hours in advance.

Northwind Labs has three offices. Office hours and office contacts are:

Office	Hours	Office contact	Email
New York	Mon-Fri 9:00 AM - 5:00 PM EST	Marcus Cole	ny-office@northwind.example
London	Mon-Fri 8:30 AM - 4:30 PM GMT	Fiona Gallagher	london-office@northwind.example
Austin	Mon-Fri 8:00 AM - 5:00 PM CST	Travis Reed	austin-office@northwind.example

3. Remote and Hybrid Work

Warehouse and facilities roles are on-site only. Operations office roles (planning, procurement) may work remotely 1 day per week with manager approval.

4. Paid Time Off

Operations employees accrue 15 days of paid time off (PTO) per year, rising to 20 days after 5 years of service. PTO requests must be submitted at least 2 weeks in advance so shifts can be covered. Up to 5 unused PTO days may be carried over into the next calendar year.

Sick leave is separate from PTO: every employee receives 8 paid sick days per year. A doctor's note is required only for absences longer than 3 consecutive work days.

Parental leave is 16 weeks fully paid for the primary caregiver and 8 weeks fully paid for the secondary caregiver.

5. Company Holidays and Closures

The following company holidays and closures apply to all departments for the 2026-2027 season:

Date	Holiday	Status
Thursday, November 26, 2026	Thanksgiving Day	All offices closed
Friday, November 27, 2026	Day after Thanksgiving	All offices closed
Thursday, December 24, 2026	Christmas Eve	Modified hours - offices close at 1:00 PM
Friday, December 25, 2026	Christmas Day	All offices closed
Friday, January 1, 2027	New Year's Day	All offices closed

Employees required to work on a company holiday receive a substitute day off, to be taken within 90 days.

6. Workplace Safety and Overtime

Steel-toe safety boots and high-visibility vests are required on the warehouse floor at all times. Hearing protection is required in areas marked as high-noise zones.

Forklifts may only be operated by employees holding a current forklift certification, which must be renewed every 3 years.

All injuries and near-misses must be reported to a shift lead and logged in the safety portal within 24 hours, no matter how minor.

Overtime must be approved by a shift lead before it is worked. Non-exempt employees are paid 1.5 times their regular rate for hours over 40 in a work week.

Warehouse inventory day is Friday, November 13, 2026. On that day the Operations floor is open 6:00 AM to 2:00 PM only.

The updated Warehouse Safety Protocol applies all week and covers logistics handling and equipment use.

7. Equipment and Allowances

Operations provides required personal protective equipment (PPE) at no cost. Employees in warehouse roles receive an annual safety-boot allowance of $150.

8. Training and Development

Every Operations employee completes annual safety refresher training in January. New hires complete safety orientation on their first day before entering the warehouse floor.

9. Benefits Enrollment

Open enrollment for health benefits runs from November 2 to November 20, 2026. New hires must enroll within 30 days of their start date.

Northwind Labs matches 401(k) contributions dollar-for-dollar up to 5% of salary. Employees are eligible for the match after 90 days of employment.

10. Conduct and Reporting Concerns

Concerns about harassment, discrimination, or safety can be reported to your manager, to Human Resources, or anonymously through the Northwind Labs ethics hotline. Retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith is prohibited.

Questions about corporate governance, regulatory compliance, or contracts go to the Legal department, led by Rachel Vance (Head of Legal).

11. Who to Contact

Operations policy questions: Devon Miller (Head of Operations).

Pay, benefits, and leave: Human Resources - Sophia Martinez (Head of HR).

Laptops, accounts, and access: the IT Help Desk.

Badges, physical security, and workplace safety incidents: Security - Nathan Brooks (Director of Security).